Bajaj General Insurance Limited

Policy for Protection of Policyholders' Interests

Background and Objective

This Policy is prepared in accordance with the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Protection of Policyholders' Interests, Operations and Allied Matters of Insurers) Regulations, 2024, issued by the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI or the Authority), along with the respective Master Circulars (herein after collectively referred to as "the Regulation").

The Regulation entrusts enhanced responsibilities on the Policyholder Protection, Grievance Redressal and Claims monitoring Committee ("PPGRCM Committee") of the Company to ensure fair treatment of prospects during the solicitation and sale of insurance policies. Its further emphasis the need for protection of policyholders' interests and to ensure that the conduct of the insurer and distribution channels are not prejudicial to the interests of the policyholders.

The objective of this Policy is to lay down the parameters for the Company and distribution channels must fulfil their obligations towards policyholders, implement standard procedures and best practices for the sale and service of policies and ensure policyholder-centric governance with a strong emphasis on grievance redressal.

1. Important Definitions

a. "Complaint" or "Grievance" means written expression (includes communication in the form of electronic mail or voice based electronic scripts) of dissatisfaction by a complainant with respect to solicitation or sale or purchase of an insurance policy or related services by insurer and /or by distribution channel.

   Explanation: An inquiry or service request would not fall within the definition of the "complaint" or "grievance".

b. "Complainant" means a policyholder or prospect or nominee or assignee or any beneficiary of an insurance policy who has filed a complaint or grievance against an insurer and /or distribution channel.

c. "Distribution Channels" include insurance agents, intermediaries or insurance intermediaries, and any persons or entities authorised by the Authority to involve in sale and service of insurance policies

d. "Mis-selling" includes sale or solicitation of policies by the insurer or through distribution channels, directly or indirectly by

   i. exercising undue influence, use of dominant position or otherwise, or
   ii. making a false or misleading statement or misrepresenting the facts or benefits, or
   iii. concealing or omitting facts, features, benefits, exclusions with respect to products, or
   iv. not taking reasonable care to ensure suitability of the policy to the prospects/policyholders.

2. Protection of Policyholders' Interests

a. Fair Treatment to policyholders

Equitable, honest and fair treatment of all prospects and policyholders shall be a core commitment of the Company throughout their entire relationship. Fair treatment of customers is deeply ingrained in the Company's culture. Special attention will be given to addressing the needs of vulnerable groups and individuals with disabilities. The Company shall ensure that prospects and policyholders can have confidence in their interactions with the Company and its distribution channels, where 'fair treatment of customers' is an integral part of the corporate culture and values.

The Company shall ensure that the products and services shall be designed to meet the needs of prospects and policyholders. Clear, simple and updated information shall be provided to prospects and policyholders, keeping them appropriately informed before, during, and after the sale, including details on costs (premium, charges, etc.), risks, exclusions or limitations and any other Terms & Conditions of the product. Products provided shall meet the requirements and reasonable expectations of prospects and policyholders.

b. Prevention of Mis-selling

- The Company shall always ensure sending welcome communication through digital modes which will include policy document along with the Customer Information Sheet to enable the policyholder with complete information related to their insurance policy including terms and conditions.
- The Company shall make all endeavor to fully inform the prospect during policy solicitation, sale stages and made aware of the benefits of the product being sold vis-a-vis the product features attached thereto along with the terms and conditions of the product. The policyholders may reach out to the Company to seek any details from the Company on policy or understanding terms & conditions.
- The Company shall establish robust processes and procedures to ensure efficient and prompt resolution of grievances raised by prospects/policyholders, adhering to the turnaround times prescribed under the Regulations.
- The Company shall take punitive action for breach of market conduct including blacklisting the salesperson/agents/intermediaries who indulge in unfair solicitation practices or market misconduct.
- The Company shall provide periodical training to agents, intermediaries, distribution channels and employees on the products (existing and new), TATs in policy servicing, changes in the regulations, code of conduct etc.

c. Servicing of Policyholder

The Company shall at all times maintain and ensure an efficient technology-based infrastructure for servicing policyholders which may include guidelines for premium collection, underwriting processes and ensure that there are no limitations for the policyholders with respect to post-sale services like portability in health policies, claim support, filing grievances etc.

d. Service Parameters including turnaround times for services rendered

The Company is fully committed to empower the policyholders by providing information on product availability, service standards, reasonable time limits for service delivery, and grievance redressal avenues. These details are outlined in the Citizens' Charter (Annexure I), which specifies service standards in both qualitative and quantitative terms and prescribe the turnaround timelines for servicing of General and Health insurance policies.

3. Insurance Awareness & Customer Education

Insurance awareness and Customer Education are ongoing efforts that shall use consistent messages by multiple channels in the integrated way. The Company's plan for insurance awareness and customer education shall be in accordance with its Policy for Insurance Awareness and Customer Education.

4. Insurance policies issued in electronic form

The Company shall enable policy issuance across various electronic and digital medium including but not limited to Company's App, email and any other such digital mediums and shall have a comprehensive approach to data security, privacy and integrity, with policies, processes and continuous monitoring and improvement measures in place to mitigate risks and comply with relevant regulations and industry standards. In this regard the Company at all times shall ensure the following:

- **Privacy Safeguards**: Measures to protect the privacy of data and information are outlined in the Information and Cyber Security policy. The Company shall periodically review and implement appropriate privacy controls.
- **System Adequacy**: Robust internal controls, process and systems are in place to prevent the manipulation of records and transactions, ensuring data security and privacy. Regular audits shall be conducted to maintain the confidentiality, integrity and availability of requisite information.
- **Data Security Framework**: A comprehensive framework for data security, including encryption, access controls, and secure backups, is implemented to protect against data breaches and unauthorized access. This framework is detailed in the board-approved Information and Cyber Security Policy and shall be reviewed periodically.
- **IT Processes**: Information Technology processes are defined and implemented according to Information Technology Infrastructure Library and Software Development Life Cycle standards. These processes are periodically reviewed for effectiveness and audited for compliance with IT General Security Controls, IRDAI Compliance Controls, ISNP, Financial Controls, KYC and PCI DSS.
- **Data Reconciliation**: Data and record reconciliation are conducted in accordance with IRDAI regulatory requirements.
- **Continuous Improvement**: As part of compliance with IRDAI, ISO 27001:2013 and the board approved Information and Cyber Security Policy, continuous reviews and upgrades of cybersecurity safeguards are performed. Regular penetration testing, vulnerability assessments and real-time monitoring of potential threats shall be carried out to stay ahead of emerging risks.

5. Unclaimed Amount

"Unclaimed Amounts" shall include any amount held by the Company, but payable to consumers/policyholders, including income accrued thereon, on account of their non-contactability through any means and remaining unpaid beyond twelve months from the due date of such payment.

A consumer shall be termed non-contactable when such consumer has not responded to any of the insurer's repeated communications for a period of twelve months. All amounts, where the consumer is not traceable, shall continue to be part of the unclaimed amounts.

"**Consumer**" refers to the proposer, policyholder, life assured, nominee, beneficiary, or any other individual with a financial interest in the policy as per its terms and conditions. Recent regulations have expanded the definition of unclaimed amounts to

include various individuals who play a vital role in the insurance policy, beyond just the insured.

The Company shall always put in maximum efforts to identify the consumers and refund such amounts back to the policyholders or allocate the same towards the policy issuance, equivalent to the efforts put in by the Company on an ongoing basis to reduce the Unclaimed amounts interalia by:

- Prompt existing policyholders at the time of payment of renewal premium (online/offine) to update their mobile number, email address, current address, bank account details, nominee details etc, by flashing existing details and send intimations accordingly.
- Make accountable the respective agents, intermediaries, group master policyholders and other distribution channels involved in the solicitation for tracing of consumers and update the contact details, bank account details etc.
- Undertake ongoing KYC for existing policies, Re-KYC of minors on immediately attaining majority.
- Put in place fool-proof systems to automatically validate mobile numbers and email addresses of existing and new consumers to ensure that these details are not of their distribution channels.
- Engage with Credit Bureaus, Account Aggregators, CSC/POS, e-commerce portals for enhancing contactability and tracing consumers.
- Advertise in Print/Digital media to reach out to consumers who are not traceable.
- In all communications (except in respect of termination/exit of contracts) sent to consumer, include a footnote advising consumer to update contact details, nominee details and bank account details in case of any change.
- To make provisions in the insurer's website / portal / App to enable policyholders to update their contacts including Email-ids, bank details and nominee details at any point of time with secure login.
- Develop online tool for processing and payment of unclaimed amounts once the consumers identify the amounts due to them on the websites of insurers while putting in place appropriate systems and controls to address fraudulent claims and practices.

Treatment of Unclaimed Amount

Any unclaimed amount of consumers lying with the Company for a period of more than 10 years as on 30 September every year, shall be transferred to Senior Citizens Welfare Fund (SCWF) on or before 1st March of the financial year.

6. Grievance Redressal System

a. Grievance Officer/s

A Grievance Redressal Officer (GRO) shall be appointed by the Company. Every office other than the Head Office of the Company shall also have a designated Grievance Officer who should be head of that office. The CEO is authorized to appoint the GRO of the Company including any subsequent changes from time to time.

b. Various channels to receive and deal grievances / complaints

- Customer Care Centre: Call center (No: 18002095858) has been set up with toll free lines, where grievances / complaints would be resolved by the Company's Customer Care Executives. IVR system would track dropped calls and customer care executives would contact such customers.

- The details of the GRO / designated Grievance Officer of respective offices along with the contact details in full shall be published on the Company's website. The name and contact details of designated Grievance Officer of respective office and the other Grievance Officers in hierarchy up to GRO at corporate office should also be displayed on the notice board of respective offices.
- Company Branches: Customers can approach any branch for resolution of their grievances / complaints. The list of branches is published on the Company website.
- E-mail: Customers can e-mail their grievances/complaints to help@bajajgeneral.co.in
- Letters: Customers can write to us; name & address given on every policy document.
- Website: Customers can also register their grievances/complaints on our website www.bajajgeneral.com
- Grievances / Complaints from customers should be dealt with in a timely manner and response on phone / email / letter should be given to each grievance / complaint.
- Customers can escalate their grievances to a higher level, if not satisfied with the response of the customer service officer.
- If not satisfied after all the escalations, the customer may write to the CEO.
- Information of the Insurance Ombudsman should also be provided, should it be required by the customer in case the grievance is not resolved fully / partially in his favour.
- Every office of the insurer shall also display in prominent place, the name, address and other contact details of the insurance ombudsman within whose jurisdiction the office falls.

c. Grievance Redressal System

- CRM should be used to register all grievance/complaints with transcripts stored, voice logs maintained and a customer care officer allocated to resolve and track each grievance/complaint.
- A system of grievance registration and disposal to be adopted in each office of the Company. The Company should publicize grievance redressal procedure and make it available on the website.
- A written acknowledgement (letter/e-mail) should be sent to the customer immediately on receiving the grievance.
- Acknowledgement letter / email should contain the name and designation of the officer who is supposed to deal with the grievance. It should also contain the grievance redressal procedure and the time taken for resolution of disputes.
- If the grievance / complaint is resolved within 3 days, then the communication of resolution should be sent along with the acknowledgement.
- Where the grievance/complaint, which is not resolved within 3 working days, it should be endeavored to resolve the grievance / complaint within 2 weeks of its receipt and a final letter of resolution should be sent to the customer.
- Where, within 2 weeks, the Company sends the complainant a written response which offers redress or rejects the complaint and gives reason for doing so, it should also inform the Complainant about the following:
    - about how he/she may further pursue the grievance/complaint, if dissatisfied.
    - that if the Company does not receive a response within 8 weeks from the date of receipt of the response, the complaint would be considered as closed.

- Seek and obtain further details, if any from the complainant within one week [permitted only once].
- MIS on all outstanding open grievance/complaints should be tracked daily.

d. Closure of Grievance/Complaint

A grievance / complaint should be considered as disposed of and closed only when the Company has acceded to the request of the complainant fully OR where the complainant has indicated in writing acceptance of the response of the Company OR where the complainant has not responded to the insurer within 8 weeks of the company's written response.

7. Settlement of claims

The Company shall have robust systems and processes to ensure quick and hassle-free settlement of claims. Decisions in respect of acceptance of claims or otherwise shall be based on submission of the requisite claim intimation and the required documents. Claim payouts will be processed to policyholders, nominees, claimants, or legal heirs, as applicable, within the defined Turnaround Times (TATs).

The claim processing TAT is as per Annexure I and applicable penal interest shall be paid in case of any delay in settlement.

8. Periodic Review of the Policy

The PPGR &CM Committee shall conduct an annual review of the Policyholder Protection Policy. The PPGR &CM Committee shall also recommend any changes to the Policy, pursuant to this review or otherwise, to the Board for its approval.

9. Provisions and Applicability of the Policy

The PPGR &CM Committee shall be empowered to make such rules and regulations for the compliance and implementation of this Policy. Any revision necessitated on account of changes in regulatory framework shall be incorporated in this Policy from the effective date thereof, as may be approved by the MD&CEO based on recommendation of PPGR &CM Committee. The revised policy shall be presented to the Board of Directors on an annual basis for noting of such changes.

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Annexure I – Citizens' Charter

Sr. No.	Service	Description	TAT
1	New Business Proposal	Processing of insurance proposal and seeking further requirements for consideration of the proposal	7 days
		Decision on proposal from the date of receipt of proposal or from the date of receipt of additional requirement whichever is later	
		Free Look Cancellation and refund of deposit from the date of receipt of the request	
		Providing copy of the policy along with proposal form/ transcript	15 days
2	Post Policy Service	Post policy Service Requests concerning mistakes/corrections in the policy document	7 days
3	Policy Servicing (From the date of request received for the service	Change of address – as per KYC norms	
		Registration/ change of nomination, assignment	
		Alteration in original policy (where applicable)	
		Change of location risk	
		Inclusion of new member in case of group policies	
		Any other non-claim related changes	
		Cancellation of policy and refund of premium	
4	Auto Action by the insurer	Premium Due intimation	One month before the due date
Claims			
5	General Retail Insurance Claim	Appointment of Surveyors (Through tech-based Solution)	24hrs
		Submission of Final Report after receiving insurer's request	15 days
		Communicating acceptance or rejection of the claim	7 days

Sr. No.	Service	Description	TAT
6	Health Insurance Claim	Acceptance of cashless claim by TPA/Company to hospital and communicate to them	1hr
		TPA's offer to settlement to the insurer/hospital after submission of document	3hr
		Settlement of claim (other the cashless)	15 days

* *Note – In the event of any ambiguity or lack of clarity regarding the legal interpretation of the above-mentioned TATs or any part thereof, the decision of the respective Functional Head shall be final. It is clarified that any such decision shall be subject to the applicable provisions of IRDAI regulations and master circulars.*

Functional head for the abovementioned clause shall be as under:

- *Chief Technical Officer for Non-Health Underwriting and Claim*
- *Sr. President – Operations, Customer Service and Grievance Redressal*
- *Head Health SBU for Health & Travel Underwriting & Claims*